

Skills for Life

Rules and tools

ESOL
Entry 3

Rules and tools

These supplementary materials are a series of reference sheets designed to support and clarify some of the language and skills objectives addressed in the ESOL Skills for Life Entry 3 learner materials. They are available for the teacher to download and distribute to the learner as required.

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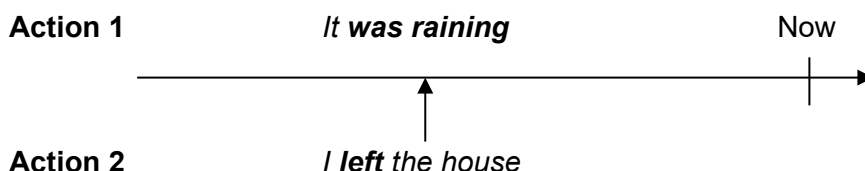
1 The past continuous

E3 Unit 1 ◀◀

General meaning

You often use the past continuous for actions or events which are interrupted or incomplete when the speaker talks about them.

*It **was raining** when I left the house.*



Was raining (Action 1) is a longer event and can continue after Action 2 is finished.

Left the house (Action 2) is a shorter event than Action 1.

Some uses of the past continuous

You can use the past continuous to:

- describe an interrupted action –
*He **was climbing** through a window when the police **arrived**.*
- express an action happening for a period of time –
*Sonya and Edouard **were living** with their grandparents between 1990 and 1992.*
- express two actions happening at the same time in the past –
*While Asma **was waiting** for the bus, Waheed **was phoning** for a taxi.*

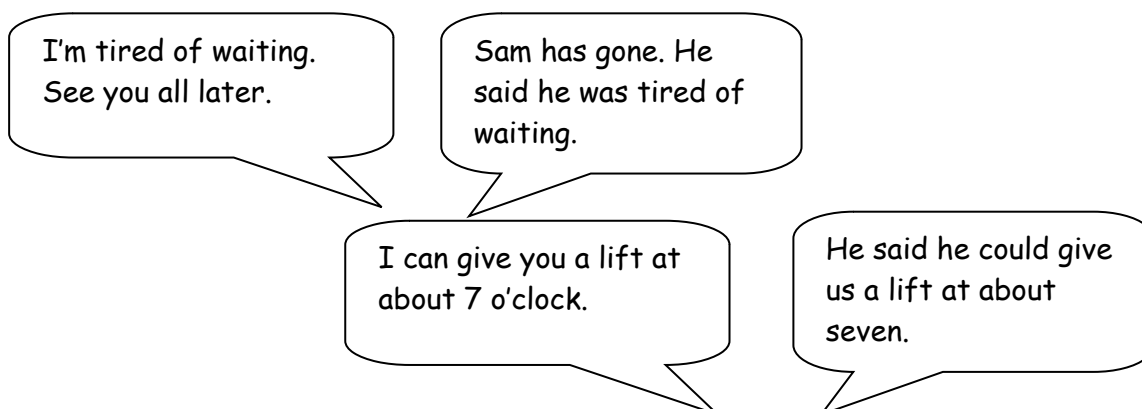
Form

You make the past continuous using *was* or *were* and the verb + *ing*.

Positive statement	<i>Leila was living in Bristol when I met her.</i> <i>I was having a party as it was my birthday.</i>
Negative statement	<i>He wasn't (was not) doing very well on his course so he left.</i> <i>We weren't (were not) playing music all night.</i>
Question	<i>Was Ali doing his coursework when you left the flat?</i> <i>Were the others getting ready to leave when you phoned home?</i>

2 Reporting what someone said

E3 Unit 1 ◀◀



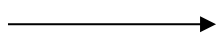
Use

- You use reported speech to tell other people what someone has said, to pass on messages, and so on. You often use *tell* or *say* to introduce reported statements.

Form

- When you use reported speech you usually put the verbs one step back into the past and change the pronouns.

Direct speech



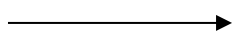
Reported speech

I'm from China.
We're waiting outside.
I can type that for you.
My brother's got a new job.

*Li said **he was** from China.*
*They said **they were** waiting outside.*
*Josh told me **he could** type it.*
*Amina told me **her** brother **had got** a new job.*

- When you report sentences in the past, the past simple can stay the same:

Direct speech



Reported speech

*I **slept** all night.*

*He said he **slept** all night.*

- You can put the word *that* in reported statements in written English, but you usually miss out *that* in spoken English.

Reported speech (written) —→ Reported speech (spoken)

*They told the police **that** the driver was a woman*

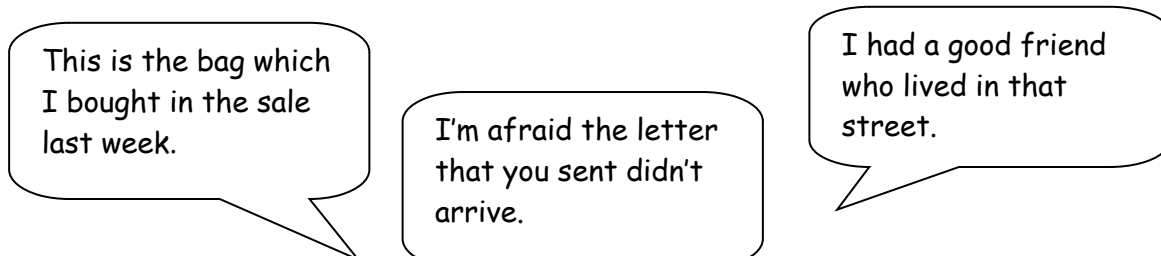
They told the police the driver was a woman.

3 Relative pronouns

E3 Unit 1 ◀◀

Use

- Relative clauses are phrases added to sentences to give extra details about a person or thing. Speakers can explain exactly who or what they are referring to when they use relative clauses.



- Relative clauses can be used when two sentences are joined.

1 I saw the doctor last night.

2 He was rude.

The doctor **who** I saw last night was rude.

Form

- Use **who** for people

I spoke to a receptionist. She was very helpful.

*I spoke to a receptionist **who** was very helpful.*

- Use **which** for things.

The bread is always very fresh. I get it at the baker's

*The bread **which** I get at the baker's, is always very fresh*

- Use **that** for people and things, especially in more informal speech.

*The bread **that** I get at the baker's is always very fresh.*

*I spoke to a receptionist **that** was very helpful.*

4 Asking indirect questions 1

E3 Unit 2◀◀

Can you tell me where the station is please?

Have you any idea what time Jyoti left?

Use

- You use indirect *wh*- questions when you want to be polite, particularly in more formal situations, or if you are not sure that the person can answer your question.

Form

- You do not use the auxiliaries *do*, *does* or *did* in indirect questions.
- You don't invert the subject of the sentence and the auxiliary or modal verbs (e.g. *is*, *are*, *was*, *will*, *have*, *can*) in indirect questions. You often do this to form direct questions.
- You use an introductory phrase (*Do you know...? Have you any idea ...? Please tell me ...?*) and then add the question word, the subject and verb to make an indirect question.

Direct question	Indirect question
Where's <i>the bank</i> ?	Please can you tell me where <i>the bank is</i> ?
When does <i>the bus</i> leave?	Do you know when <i>the bus leaves</i> ?
Who did <i>you</i> see last night?	Can you tell me who <i>you saw</i> last night?
What present will <i>you</i> buy?	Have you decided what present <i>you will buy</i> ?
Why was <i>the train</i> late?	Do you know why <i>the train was</i> late?
How much are <i>the cakes</i> ?	Can you tell me how much <i>the cakes are</i> ?
How fast can <i>you</i> type?	Please tell me how fast <i>you can type</i> ?

Common mistakes

- Using 'direct question' order in indirect questions:
Can you tell me where is the station? ✗
Can you tell me where the station is? ✓
- Forgetting to miss out *do*, *does* or *did*:
*Do you know when **does** the match begin?* ✗
Do you know when the match begins? ✓

5 Giving advice: *should*

E3 Unit 3◀◀

I'm not registered with a dentist and I've got really bad toothache. What should I do?

Oh you should try my dentist. He's really good. You should ring now and see if he can fit you in.

Use

- You give advice when you suggest actions to other people. Using the word *should* is a common way of asking for and offering advice in both formal and informal situations.

Form

- Should* is a modal verb. It is followed by the infinitive of the main verb without *to*.

Sentence	<i>You should take more exercise.</i> <i>You should ask for some time off work.</i>
Negative	<i>Mumtaz shouldn't eat a lot of sweet things.</i> <i>You shouldn't work so hard .</i>
Question	<i>Should I take the tablets before or after meals?</i> <i>Should I see him now ?</i>

- Should* is a modal verb which does not change form

	First person	Second person	Third person
Singular	<i>I should go.</i>	<i>You should go.</i>	<i>He/She should go.</i>
Plural	<i>We should go.</i>	<i>You should go.</i>	<i>They should go.</i>

Common errors

- Using *to* before the main verb or adding *-ing* to the main verb:

*She should **to** get it from the chemist. ✗*
*He should **going** home early. ✗*

She should get it from the chemist ✓
He should go home early. ✓

6 Using *will* for future arrangements

E3 Unit 3◀◀

Wait a minute. I'll just put a dressing on that cut.

Don't worry, I'll make sure she leaves on time.

No, I won't let him drive my car. He's not insured.

The doctor's with a patient now but she will see you in a few minutes.

I'll meet you at the café at about five.

Will you sign here, please?

- Use *will* to talk about an arrangement which is about to happen or is in the very near future.
- Use *will* to make a promise or to offer to do something for someone.
- Use *will* when asking someone to do something.
- Use *won't* (*will not*) when refusing to do something.

Form

- *Will* is a modal verb. It is followed by the infinitive of the main verb without *to*.
- *will* does not change its form according to person or singular and plural.

	First person	Second person	Third person
Singular	I'll (<i>will</i>) go.	You'll (<i>will</i>) go.	He/She'll (<i>will</i>) go.
Plural	We'll (<i>will</i>) go.	You'll (<i>will</i>) go.	They'll (<i>will</i>) go.

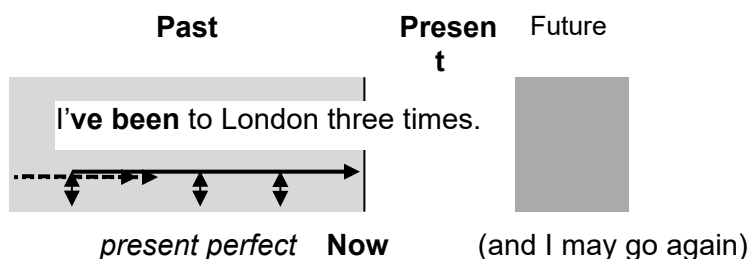
- The negative of *will* is *won't*.
*The nurse **won't** arrive till five. There **won't** be anyone there now.*
- In speech we usually use the contracted form *'ll* or *won't* in sentences.
*I'll be with you in a minute. We **won't** forget to contact you.*

7 The present perfect: introduction

E3 Unit 4◀◀

General meaning

- You use the present perfect for finished actions or past events which are connected to or continue in the present.



Some uses of the present perfect

- To describe past experiences (we don't say or know when they happened)
*Marie **has been** to Australia but she's never **been** to Canada.*
***Has** Akbar **spoken** to the travel agent yet?*
- To describe very recent events.
*I've just **got back** from Bristol.*
*Azza's just **broken** her case.*
- To describe events or actions with results in the present.
*Feliz **has lost** the tickets!*
*They **haven't given** us seats by the window!*
- To describe events or actions which started in the past and continue to the present.
*Samira **has lived** in Bolton for the last 10 years.*
*I've **worked** as a tourist guide since I left college.*

Form

- You make the present perfect using *has* or *have* and the past participle of verbs, e.g. waited, stopped, been, gone.

Sentence	<i>Rekha's just got back from Manchester.</i> <i>I've visited Bath twice.</i> <i>We've already received our tickets, thank you.</i>
Negative	<i>You haven't done very well on that deal.</i> <i>Ali hasn't met Younis yet.</i> <i>They've never been to Ireland.</i>
Question	<i>Has Peter ever been to Blackpool Pleasure Beach?</i> <i>Have Samia and Feroza arrived yet?</i> <i>You have reserved the hotel, haven't you?</i>

- In speech you usually use the contracted forms of *have* and *has* in sentences.
*They've **booked** the tickets. It's **stopped** raining. I've **forgotten** my money!*
- The participles are generally the same for past tense and past perfect. A few are different, e.g. *go, went, gone* ; *do, did, done*. It is a good idea to use your verb list and learn them by heart.

8 Adjectives: superlatives E3 Unit 4◀

Newcastle is one of the most attractive cities I've been to.

Manchester is one of the liveliest cities I've lived in .

I think Birmingham is one of the friendliest cities I know.

Bath is one of the most beautiful cities I've visited.

Use

- You use superlative adjectives to compare three or more people, places or things. e.g.

*This is **the most** expensive hotel in Bradford and it's one of **the** oldest.*

Form

- You use *the* with superlative adjectives, e.g.
*Chester is one of **the** best places for a tourist to visit.*
- You form the superlative adjectives as follows.

Most adjectives with one syllable Some with two syllables	All adjectives with three or more syllables Some adjectives with two syllables	Irregular adjectives
Add – <i>est</i> to the end of the adjective: <i>new</i> newest <i>lively</i> liveliest	Use <i>most</i> in front of the adjective: <i>interesting</i> most <i>interesting</i> <i>common</i> most common	Learn by heart: <i>good</i> <i>better</i> best <i>bad</i> <i>worse</i> worst <i>little</i> <i>less</i> least

Spelling

- When adding –*est* to one syllable adjectives which end with a vowel and a consonant, double the consonant, e.g. *big*, **biggest**.
- When adding –*est* to one syllable adjectives which end with *e*, miss out one *e*, e.g. *nice*, **nicest** (not *niceest*).
- When adding –*est* to two syllable adjectives which end with *y*, change *y* to *i*, e.g. *busy*, **busiest**.

9 Past habits – *used to do*

E3 Unit 5◀

When I was young we didn't use to have television or telephones.

Where did you use to live before you moved here?

I used to live in north London.

Meaning

- This is used to describe habits, situations or a series of events in the past which no longer happen.

Past	Present
Telephones used to be very rare.	Telephones aren't rare now.

Form

- used to* is followed by a base verb e.g. *She used to ride a bike.*
- used to* does not change its form according to person or singular and plural.
- used to* follows the grammar of past tense verbs:

Sentence	<i>Hassan used to have a bicycle but it was stolen.</i>
Negative	<i>When I lived in London, I didn't use to have a car.</i>
Question	<i>Did he use to have a car? How did you use to get about?</i>

Common errors

- Missing out the *-d*
*She **use** to type on a type writer.* *She **used** to type on a typewriter.*
- Adding *-ing* to the main verb after *used to*:
*He used to **typing** his own letters.* *He used to **type** his own letters.*
- Adding *-ed* to the main verb after *used to*.
*They didn't use to **owned** a computer.* *They didn't use to **own** a computer.*

10 Degrees of future possibility: E3 Unit 5◀ modals and adverbs

Those mobiles might be cheaper in the sales next week.

They will probably reduce the prices of all of these things. It may be better to wait until then.

Use

- You can express degrees of future possibility with the modal verbs *will*, *may* and *might*.

It won't rain today.	It may might rain.	It may not might not rain	It'll rain today.
certain confidant prediction	←	possible unsure	→ certain confidant prediction

- You can also express degrees of future possibility by modifying *will* with the adverbs *possibly*, *probably*, *almost certainly* and *certainly*.

It'll possibly rain today.	It'll probably rain today.	It'll almost certainly rain.	It'll certainly rain today	It'll rain today. It won't rain today.
possible but unsure →				certain

Form

- May* and *might* are modal verbs. They are followed by the infinitive of the main verb without *to*.
- May* and *might* do not change their form according to person or singular and plural.

	First person	Second person	Third person
Singular	I may go. might	You may go. might	He/She may go might .
Plural	We may go. might	You may go. might	They may go. might

- The negative of *may* is *may not*. The negative of *might* is *might not*, e.g
I may not come tomorrow. He might not pass his driving test.

11 Phrasal verbs

E3 Unit 5◀

Why don't you look up her number in the telephone directory?

Hold on. I'll just put you through.

If you want to sign up for the aerobics class, please fill in this form.

Meaning and use

- Phrasal verbs are common, especially in spoken English and in informal writing. They are often used to replace a more formal verb.
e.g. *Please complete this form.* → *Please fill in this form.*

Form

- Prepositions (e.g. *at, up, in*) are added to verbs (e.g. *go, get*) to make phrasal verb (e.g. *go away, get at*) which has a meaning of its own. This meaning is often very different to the meaning of the original verb.
- Phrasal verbs can take the same range of tenses as other verbs.
e.g. *They're putting up the aerial. She'll put on goggles later. Ali put off the job until later.*
- There are three groups of phrasal verbs.

1. Phrasal verbs with no object	2. Phrasal verbs with objects in end-position	3. Phrasal verbs with objects in mid or end-position
<i>They sat down.</i> (on a chair) <i>Look out!</i> (There's a car.) <i>They dropped in.</i> (for a chat)	<i>He looked after the video.</i> <i>She searched for the radio.</i> <i>I looked forward to a break.</i>	<i>She put down the phone.</i> <i>She put the phone down.</i> <i>He tidied up the mess.</i> <i>He tidied the mess up.</i>

- Pronouns (e.g. *it, us, her, them*) used as the object of the verb can only be used in mid-position with phrasal verbs in group 3.

With object

*Faiza wrote down **the words**.* ✓

*Faiza wrote **the words** down.* ✓

With pronoun as object

*Faiza wrote **them** down.* ✓

*Faiza wrote down **them**.* ✗

12 Zero conditional sentences

E3 Unit 5◀◀

If you do a search
look on the internet
you find information
about all sorts of
things.

You'll type much more
quickly if you learn to
touch-type.

*Water freezes if the
temperature falls below zero.*

Use

- Zero conditional sentences are used to give advice, instructions or to describe true facts about the world.

Form

- Zero conditional sentences have two clauses. The *if*-clause begins with *if*. The second clause is the *result clause*.

If-clause
Result clause

↓
↓

If you want a good picture, use an aerial.

- Insert a comma after the *if*-clause:
If you want to install an aerial, contact an aerial fitter.
- The result clause can go in front of the *if*-clause. In this case, no comma is necessary.

Result clause
If-clause

↓
↓

Contact an aerial fitter if you want to install an aerial.

- Zero conditional sentences use verbs in present tenses. Verbs in the result clause are often in the imperative.

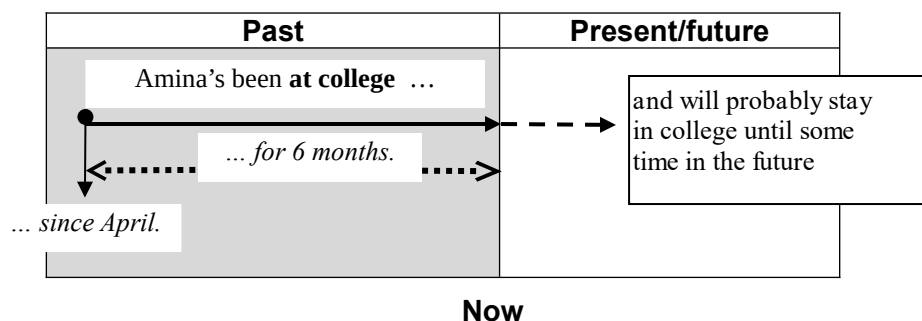
If you don't get a clear picture, check the aerial.
If your hands are wet, don't touch electrical equipment.

13 The present perfect with *for* and *since*

E3 Unit 6

Use

- The present perfect is often used with *for* and *since* and a time expression to express actions or situations which started in the past and continue to the present. They may or may not continue in the future.



Form

- Use *for* with periods of time, e.g.

*I've had this book **for** a month.*
*I've used this computer **for** ages.*

- Use *since* with points in time, e.g.

*John and Karen have studied maths **since** 2002.*
*Rahul has had the same teacher **since** last September.*

- The present perfect is also used with other time expressions: *before*, *ever*, *never*, *already* and *just*, e.g.

*Have you used a computer with a CD writer **before**?*
*Have you **ever** studied IT skills?*
*Vikram has **already** done the work.*

Common errors

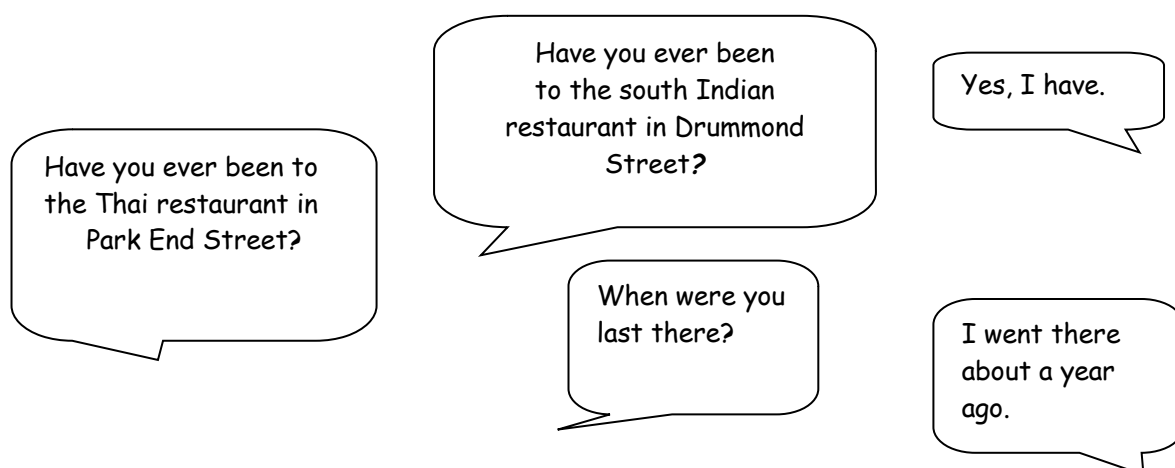
- Using past simple tense instead of present perfect changes the meaning, e.g.

I've lived here for two years. (Meaning - until now)
I lived here for two years. (Meaning - That was some time ago. I moved to another place.)

- Confusing *for* (for a period of time) and *since* (from a point in the past) e.g.
I haven't seen her since two days. ✗ *I haven't seen her for two days.* ✓

14 Using the present perfect and the past simple

E3 Unit 7 ◀◀



Use

- The present perfect and the past simple express different aspects of past time. You use the present perfect for past experiences, news, actions and events which happened in the past but you don't say when they happened. You use the past simple for completed actions in the past when you say the time (or when the time is clear from the situation).



- You often begin a conversation in the present perfect when we are not sure if an event has taken place. Once you know when the event happened, then you change to the past simple.
- Some time phrases are generally used with the past simple while others are generally used with the present perfect:

Expressions with past simple

yesterday

at 11.30 (any times)

in June 2002 (months and years)

on Monday (other days of week)

last week (month, year etc.)

two days (weeks, months etc.) **ago**

Expressions with present perfect

ever

never

yet and **already**

just

for three hours (day, weeks etc.)

since yesterday (Friday, March etc)

15 Asking indirect questions (2)

E3 Unit 8◀



Use

- You use indirect questions when you want to be polite, particularly in more formal situations, or if you are not sure the person can answer your question. See Asking Indirect Questions (1)

Form

- You use an introductory phrase (*Do you know...? Have you any idea ...? Please tell me ...?*) to make an indirect question.
- When you ask indirect *yes/no* questions, this phrase is followed by *if* or *whether*.
- You don't invert the subject of the sentence and the auxiliary or modal verbs (e.g. *is, are, was, will, have, can*) in indirect questions. You often do this to form direct questions.

Direct yes/no question

Can you come for an interview?

Indirect yes/no question

*Can you confirm **whether** you can come for an interview.*

- If you use *whether* instead of *if* , it shows you think that there are two or more different options *If* is often used in more informal spoken situations, e.g.
*The waiter asked **whether** I would like coffee. (or not)*
- You do not use the auxiliaries *do, does* or *did* in indirect questions

Direct question	Indirect question
Is there a bank near here?	Please can you tell me whether there's a bank near here?
Is this the right bus for Rose Hill?	Do you know if this is the right bus for Rose Hill?
Is he coming with us?	Can you tell me whether he's coming with us?
Are you leaving soon?	Have you decided whether you are leaving soon?
Was the train late?	Do you know if the train was late?

16 Reading skills

E3 – skills◀◀

Skimming

Skimming means:

- Looking at: the beginnings or ends of paragraphs, sentences, words or headings to give you a **general idea** about what you are reading.
- reading something quickly
- not reading every word
- not using a dictionary

What kind of text do you skim read?

- leaflets
- newspaper articles
- posters

Scanning:

Scanning means:

- Looking at: sentences, words, headings or numbers to find **important information**.
- reading something quickly
- not reading every word
- not using a dictionary

What kind of text do you scan?

- a telephone book
- an instruction booklet
- a newspaper article leaflet or poster for information like a date, a time or about important events

Detailed reading

Detailed reading means:

- Reading the text **carefully** because you want to understand everything.
- using a dictionary

What kind of text do you read in detail?

- a letter from the bank
- a recipe
- instructions

17 Listening skills

E3 – skills◀◀

Prediction

Prediction helps you to understand what you are going to listen to. Prediction means: **before** you listen, thinking about:

- why you are listening
- what the situation is
- who is speaking
- what people are going to say

Listening for gist

Listening for gist means:

- listening for a **general** idea of what someone is saying
- not listening to every word
- listening for stressed words
- listening for intonation

When do you listen for gist?

- face to face conversations
- telephone conversations
- radio and TV programmes
- the first time you listen to a tape in class

Listening for detail

Listening for detail means:

- listening **carefully** for important information
- listening for stressed words
- listening for repeated words
- listening for the past, present or future tenses
- checking you understand in a conversation

When do you listen for detail?

- instructions
- directions
- explanations
- announcements
- the second time you listen to a tape in class

Remember!

The most important thing about listening: relax! – Don't try to understand everything.

18 Speaking

E3 – skills ◀◀

How to stress the right word in a sentence.

Stress means... making a word: a little bit longer a little bit louder

Which words are stressed?

In English we stress the important word or words in a sentence to add meaning. e.g.

Tickets please? (I want to see your **ticket**)

We can change the stress to change the meaning a little bit e.g

Can I **see** your ticket please? (I want to **see** your ticket not to hear about it)

Can I see your ticket please? (Show your ticket to **me** not my colleague)

Why is stress important?

- Listening for stressed words helps you understand someone without understanding every word.
- Stressing important words helps people to understand what you are saying.

How to use intonation in questions

Intonation means:

Making your voice go up or down near the end of a question.

Wh- questions

Your voice usually goes down at the end of wh questions.

[[Insert downwards arrows through name and live]]

What's your *name*?

Where do you *live*?

Questions with can/could

Your voice usually goes up near the end of can/could questions

Can I *help* you?

Could you tell me where the station *is* please?

19 Spelling

E3 – skills◀◀

Learning to spell well in English needs lots of practice. Here are a few ideas to help.

- Look at errors in your writing, or new words which come up in lesson. Decide which new spellings would be most useful to learn. Choose only a few to begin with.
- Look at each new word. Decide which bit is difficult and try to think of a way of remembering it. Here are a few ideas
 - Underline the difficult bit in the word e.g. building, remember.
 - Find words you know with the same pattern e.g. fright, light, sight.
 - Look for words inside words e.g. **cap**-a-city.
 - Remember a trick for remembering e.g. to separate = to **pa**rt.
 - Change the way the word sounds e.g. Wed-nes-day.
- Keep a list of these new spellings. It is useful to make a table in your file with space to practise each new word in a systematic way.

New word	1 st practice	2 nd practice	3 rd practice	Meaning/ translation
environment	enviroment	environment		

Then as you practise each word, try the 'Look, Say, Cover, Write, Check' method.

- Look at the word carefully.
- Say it aloud.
- Cover it up.
- Write it again.
- Check that it is correct.

Repeat this the next day and again after a few more days. This will help to get the spelling of the word into your long-term memory.

It is also useful to get someone to test you on your spellings.

20 Vocabulary: learning new words E3 – skills ◀◀

First, think about how you learn and remember new words. What kind of words do you remember? What kind do you forget? Do you remember best by hearing and/or by seeing words written down? Is it useful to play with words?

Keeping a vocabulary notebook

Remembering new words involves more than just writing a translation.

Explore different ways of making a record of new words. Think about which way suits you.

- Group words for situations or topics in word webs, in lists, as opposites and synonyms.
- Pictures help you remember words by thinking about what they look like.
- Practice words by listening to the radio and TV, eavesdropping, reading
- Experiment with new words as much as you can
- Note the grammar with V (verb) A (adjective) or N (noun) to help you remember where and how to use the word in a sentence.
- Mark the stress by underlining or putting a large dot above the stressed syllable so that you remember how to say a word.
- New words set in sample sentences helps you to remember when and how to use them.
- Use a good English –English dictionary, a Thesaurus and English language textbooks for expanding vocabulary

economise V *I must economise. I'm spending too much money.*

economy N *The Government is trying to improve the economy.*

economical A *Mobile phones are not very economical.*

Remember

The best way to remember a new word is to use it.